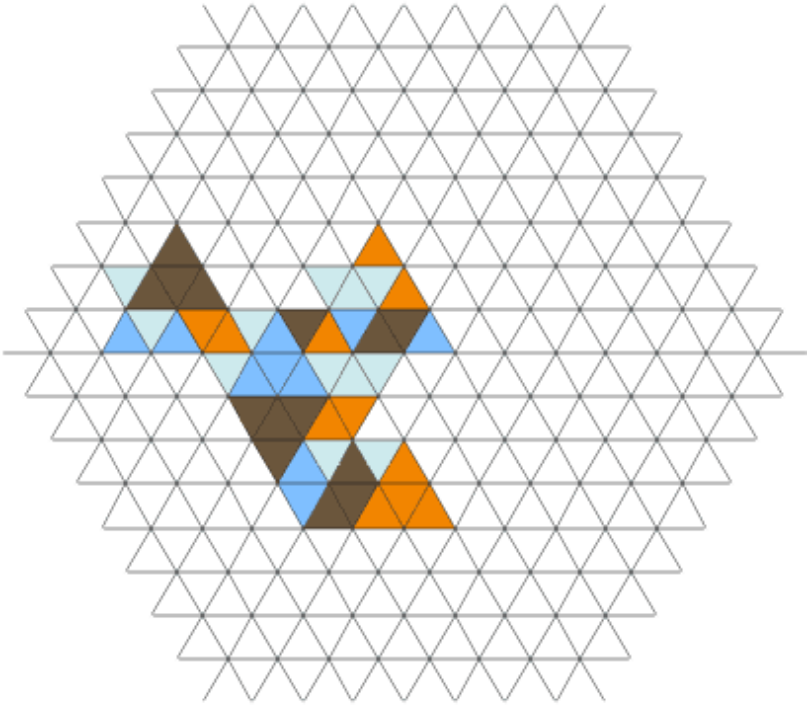
Foliage

2026, Dale Walton, https://boardgamegeek.com/thread/3786470

Equipment: The Board is a large triangular grid. There are triangular pieces in 4 colors. Each piece is the size of four grid unit triangles. The players each receive a fixed number of pieces of two colors, for their use in play.



the board starts empty
(the name comes from imagining leaves at the bottom of a puddle in the fall)

The game is played by placing triangles at least partially over-top of one or more triangles already in play. No triangle may be fully covered in this process, and no triangle may be placed in contact with a visible part of the same color (not even at corners) The goal is to have areas of your color with edges that touches all three of the other colors.

The winner is the player whose colors cover the most unit triangles in those areas.

For a beginner's game start with six of each.

To start, one player places a triangle near the center of the board.

Play alternates without passing

The game ends and is scored when one player cannot move.

Author’s words:

The second player advantage comes because delaying your turn would allow you to take advantage of the other player's positional commitments. Offering komi is probably the most straight-forward way to balance this effect.

In the first version of the game a player may also have fairly limited options on any given turn, so it is possible to force the opponent to give up some points and/or to to force them to place where you can score off them later.

If there is a place to score that the opponent cannot block, don't be in a rush to claim it, unless claiming it doesn't open up scoring opportunities for your opponent and you are trying to stall placing elsewhere. Instead, simply avoid blocking your ability to claim it later.

In the smaller version, play is not restricted to overlapping, so one could try playing just one color to maximize one's freedom to later take advantage of playing the other color later.

Scorable regions of a unit triangle size cannot be covered or de-scored, due to the color restriction on placement. Thus building up singles is an important way to build an advantage, but larger scoring may prove pivotal.

The score of larger regions can frequently be reduced by partially covering them - which can also possibly totally disconnect them from a color, - and/or, by covering one of the surrounding colors. Of course, the covering piece must not prevented from fitting there due to previous placements.

Opportunities and risks of playing at the edges of the board are higher because larger regions (eg. full pieces) are harder to attack there, but also harder to score.

One must not overlook the ocassional possibility of placing a triangle over multiple pieces that already completely fill an area. This kind of placement is usually hard to attack, and thus, if it scores, is very beneficial. However the opportunity is rare and hard to see.